SPECIFICATION OF THE PROTECTED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN "CASSIS"

approved by decree no. 2011-1505 of 10 November 2011, JORF of 15 November 2011

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin "Cassis", initially recognised by the decree of 15 May 1936.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

No particular provision.

III. – Colour and types of product

The controlled designation of origin "Cassis" is reserved for still white, red and rosé wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines are carried out within the territory of the commune of Cassis in the Bouches-du-Rhône department.

2° – Delimited parcel area

The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the competent national committee of the National Institute of Origin and Quality. The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town hall of Cassis the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines, is made up of the territory of the commune of Roquefort-la-Bédoule in the Bouches-du-Rhône department.

V. – Grape varieties

1° – Grape varieties

The wines come from the following varieties:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	GRAPE VARIETIES
White wines	- main varieties: clairette B, marsanne B; - accessory varieties: bourboulenc B (locally called "doucillon blanc"), pascal B, sauvignon B, terret blanc B and ugni blanc B.
Rosé wines	- main varieties: cinsaut N, grenache N and mourvèdre N; - accessory varieties: barbaroux Rs, bourboulenc B (locally called "doucillon blanc"), carignan N, clairette B, marsanne B, pascal B, sauvignon B, terret noir N and ugni blanc B.
Red wines	- main varieties: cinsaut N, grenache N and mourvèdre N; - accessory varieties: barbaroux Rs, carignan N and terret noir N.

2° – Proportion rules on the holding

The conformity of the grape varieties is assessed, for the colour considered, over all of the parcels of the holding producing the wine of the controlled designation of origin.

COLOUR OF THE WINES	PROPORTION RULES

White wines	- The proportion of the main varieties is greater than or equal to 60 % of the grape varieties; - the proportion of the marsanne B variety is between 30 % and 80 % of the grape varieties; - the proportion of the terret blanc B variety is less than or equal to 5 % of the grape varieties.
Rosé wines	- The proportion of all the main varieties is greater than or equal to 70 % of the grape varieties; - the proportion of all the bourboulenc B, clairette B, marsanne B, pascal B, sauvignon B and ugni blanc B varieties is less than or equal to 20 % of the grape varieties; - the proportion of the terret noir N variety is less than or equal to 5 % of the grape varieties.
Red wines	- The proportion of all the main varieties is greater than or equal to 70 % of the grape varieties; - the proportion of the terret noir N variety is less than or equal to 5 % of the grape varieties.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density.
Each plant has a maximum area of 2.50 square metres. This area is obtained by multiplying the inter-row and plant-spacing distances within the same row. The spacing between rows may not be greater than 2.50 metres and the spacing between plants within the same row may not be less than 0.80 metre.

b) – Pruning rules.
The vines are pruned by short pruning, with a maximum of 2 free eyes (buds) per spur (trained in goblet, fan or Royat cordon) and, at most, 6 spurs per plant, that is to say a total of 12 free eyes maximum per plant.

c) – Trellising rules and foliage height.
For the vines trained according to the "raised single-plane trellising" mode, the height of the trellised foliage, after topping, must be at least equal to 0.35 times the spacing between rows. The height of trellised foliage is measured between the lower limit of the foliage, established at least 0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper topping limit, established at least 0.20 metre above the upper trellising wire.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel.
- The average maximum load per parcel is fixed at 7,500 kilograms per hectare; - when irrigation is authorised, in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, the average maximum load per parcel of the irrigated parcels is fixed at 6,000 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Threshold for missing vines.
The percentage of dead or missing vine plants, referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, is fixed at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine.
The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

In order to preserve the characteristics of the physical and biological environment that constitutes a fundamental element of the terroir:

a) – The operations of disbudding and de-suckering of the plants, contributing to the control of the yields, are carried out by exclusively manual or mechanical means;

b) – The addition of exogenous soil onto parcels of the delimited parcel area is prohibited; by exogenous soil is meant a soil that does not come from the delimited parcel area of the controlled designation of origin "Cassis".

3° – Irrigation

Irrigation during the vegetative period of the vine may be authorised, in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, only in the event of persistent drought and when the latter disturbs the good physiological development of the vine and the good ripeness of the grape.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

The wines come from grapes harvested at proper ripeness.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) – Sugar richness of the grapes.
Grapes presenting a sugar richness greater than or equal to the following are considered as being at proper ripeness:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	MINIMUM SUGAR RICHNESS OF THE GRAPES (grams per litre of must)
White and rosé wines	187
Red wines	198

b) – Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume.
The wines present the following minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	MINIMUM NATURAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME
White and rosé wines	11 %
Red wines	11.5 %

VIII. – Yields. – Entry into production

1° – Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 45 hectolitres per hectare.

2° – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 45 hectolitres per hectare.

3° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may be granted to wines coming from: - parcels of young vines only from the 3rd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July; - parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July; - parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 2nd year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By way of derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the grape varieties of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Blending of the varieties.
The red and rosé wines come from the blending of grapes or of wines representative of the grape-variety rules and of the proportion rules on the holding. For the white wines: - the proportion of marsanne B in the blend is between 20 % and 80 %, while respecting the grape-variety limits of the holding; - the proportion of the main varieties is greater than or equal to 60 % of the blend; - the proportion of the terret blanc B variety is less than or equal to 5 % of the blend.

b) – Malolactic fermentation.
At the packaging stage, the red wines present a malic acid content less than or equal to 0.4 gram per litre.

c) – Analytical standards.
The wines present, after fermentation, a content of fermentable sugars less than or equal to:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	MAXIMUM CONTENT OF FERMENTABLE SUGARS (glucose + fructose) (grams per litre)
White and rosé wines	4
Red wines	3

d) – Oenological practices and physical treatments.
- The use of wood chips is prohibited; - for the elaboration of the rosé wines, the use of charcoal for oenological use is authorised only for the musts and new wines still in fermentation, arising from pressing, within the limit of 10 % maximum of the volume of rosé wines elaborated by the vinifier concerned, for the harvest considered and at a maximum dose of 60 grams per hectolitre.

e) – Vat capacity.
Every operator has a global vat capacity greater than or equal to the product of the yield referred to in 1° of point VIII by the area in production vinified in the cellar.

f) – Upkeep of the cellar and equipment.
The cellar and the vinification equipment present a good general condition of upkeep.

2° – Provisions by type of product

The wines are the subject of an ageing at least until 15 January of the year following that of the harvest.

3° – Provisions relating to packaging

a) – The operator respects a cleaning procedure for the bottling unit.

b) – For each packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body: - the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code; - an analysis carried out before or after packaging. The analysis reports are kept for a period of 3 months from the date of packaging.

4° – Provisions relating to storage

a) – The operator demonstrates a specific place for the storage of the packaged products.

b) – A sufficient means of thermal control protecting the wines from any excessive temperature rise is implemented within the buildings or the vats where the wines are conserved.

5° – Provisions relating to the movement of products and to placing on the market for the consumer

a) – Date of placing on the market for the consumer.
At the end of the ageing period, the wines are placed on the market for the consumer from 1 February of the year following that of the harvest.

b) – Period during which the wines may not move between approved warehouse keepers.
The wines may move between approved warehouse keepers at the earliest on 15 January of the year following that of the harvest.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The geographical area lies within a vast amphitheatre widely open to the Mediterranean Sea by a magnificent bay, girdled by marked reliefs constituted by the formations of reef and dolomitic limestones: - to the south-east, by the high Turonian cliffs of Cap Canaille, whose altitude reaches 416 metres; - to the north-east, by the "couronne de Charlemagne" and the hills of the Bois de la Marcouline; - to the north, by Mont Carpiagne; - to the south-west, by the massif of La Gardiole. It is situated some twenty kilometres from Marseille, on the sole commune of Cassis, within which the parcel area for the harvesting of the

grapes has been carefully delimited. The heart of this amphitheatre is constituted of wooded hills and small elongated depressions oriented south-west/north-east and modelled in the clayey-calcareous formations of the Cenomanian. The climatic situation is particularly privileged for viticulture, with average temperatures of 23 °C in summer, 17 °C in autumn, 11 °C in winter. This territory benefits from an average annual sunshine of 3,000 hours and an average annual rainfall of 670 millimetres. The precipitation is however irregular over the course of the year and from one year to another, as in all the Mediterranean zone. Frosts there are exceptional — Cassis is moreover one of the rare communes not to have suffered from the frost of 1956 — and the risks of hail there are very low. Moreover, the amphitheatre topography, closed towards the north, protects the vineyard from the influences of the Mistral, a cold, dry and sometimes violent wind that marks the climate of the neighbouring vineyards. Conversely, the geographical area is open to the beneficial influence of the sea breezes that temper the excesses of the Provençal climate, particularly during the summer. The agricultural surface of the commune is very limited, representing less than 10 % of its area. The vineyard is distributed over 3 slope systems: - "Le Plan", situated to the west, of small area and relatively flat topography despite a few hillsides present in its northern part; - "Les Janots", a sector delimited by a small valley of south-west/north-east orientation that extends from the "Bagnol" to the "Janots" with hillsides present on the south-east face of the "Rompides"; - finally, the slopes that extend from the "Pignier" and the "Revestel" to the "Janots"; the gentle slopes in the piedmont ("Pignier") are increasingly steep as they rise towards the "barres" or rocky escarpments ("La Saoupe", "Le Baou Redon"); this sector of hillsides, with very fine slopes, represents the main viticultural sector of "Cassis", alongside the "Pignier" and the "Revestel", and christened "quartier" (or "climat") of "La Douane". On these three slope systems, whose parcels present well-drained clayey-calcareous soils, the vineyard rises in tiers at an altitude between about 10 metres and 150 metres and extends from the seaside to 3.5 kilometres inland. A large part of this vineyard is cultivated in terraces or "restanques", both on the steeply sloping hillside and in the small valley laid out like a great staircase.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Viticulture has always been the dominant sector of the agriculture of Cassis. Already flourishing at the time of the Roman domination, its situation on the edge of the coast protected it from the barbarian invasions of the 8th and 11th centuries. Under CHARLES IX, the vineyard of "Cassis" begins to produce a little white wine. It is however to King RENÉ of ANJOU, Count of Provence, on his return to Provence after the loss of the kingdom of Naples in 1442, that the introduction of the "muscatel" variety is attributed. Paul du LAC, abbot of Saint-Victor, Lord of La Ciotat, contributes to the development of this variety, which then makes the renown of "Cassis". Around 1520, the Florentine family of the ALBIZZI settles in Cassis and introduces there new "muscatel" varieties, which it plants widely. The people of Cassis progressively extend the cultivation of the vine over all of their territory, and the archives of the 16th century make mention of the northern and eastern quarters that are added to those already existing in 1430 in the south-eastern part. The vineyard then represents 200 hectares for a production of 3,000 to 4,000 hectolitres of red and white wine. About a quarter is elaborated from this famous "muscat" that produces a liqueur or spirituous wine. On the eve of the Revolution, between 1786 and 1788, John FISCH, a Swiss traveller, crosses France. In the account he gives of his journey, he first shows himself very critical of the Provençal winegrowers but then praises the "exceptional crus" of Lamalgue, Cassis and Aubagne. This production subsists until the phylloxera destruction. Thereafter, the vineyard, totally annihilated, is rehabilitated without "muscatel" and without "mourvèdre", which do not offer all the qualitative guarantees with the rootstocks used. Around 1929, the vineyard is entirely reconstituted. The clairette B and marsanne B varieties progressively occupy an increasingly important place among the grape varieties dedicated to the white wines that carry the notoriety of "Cassis" and that then represent the most important part of the production. The vineyard of "Cassis" is recognised among the very first controlled designations of origin by decree dated 15 May 1936. The surfaces planted with vine remain stable, from 240 hectares in 1959 to 200 hectares in 1978. The vineyard extends, in 2009, over an area of 204 hectares, of which 10 hectares of young vines. The area planted with white varieties is 129 hectares, that is to say 66 % of the vineyard, for an average annual production of 4,700 hectolitres, and the area planted with black varieties is 59 hectares. The production is elaborated by 11 private estates, of which one has its seat on the neighbouring commune of Roquefort-la-Bédoule.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

The production of white wines represents about 70 % of the total production. These wines are dry, round, with complex aromas with discreet floral, fruity and balsamic olfactory notes. The proximity of the sea confers on them an iodised character, an almost salty vivacity. "Wines for the mouth" (vins de bouche), they marry perfectly with bouillabaisse, seafood or fish soup, local specialities. These wines are generally drunk young but keep easily for 2 to 3 years. The rosé wines occupy an increasingly important place and represent, in 2009, about 30 % of the production. Elaborated by pressing and bleeding (saignée), they often present aromas of red fruits and citrus. The production of red wine is confidential but sought-after for the generous character of the wines. Produced essentially from old vines, they generally offer notes of leather and undergrowth, with a tannic structure well present but melted.

3° – Causal interactions

The conjunction of a dry mesoclimate tempered by the maritime influence, of a topography in the form of an amphitheatre open to the bay of Cassis, and of clayey-calcareous soils on hillsides protected by dry-stone walls, confers on all of the Cassis vineyard, essentially situated on slopes of north-west exposure, ripeness conditions favourable for all of its varieties and very particularly for the white varieties clairette B and marsanne B. Indeed, the combined effects of the sunshine, of the temperatures whose ranges are limited by the maritime influence, of the protection of the sometimes abrupt slopes, permit these varieties to give grapes offering a balance quite specific for the Provençal vineyard, combining structure, complex aromatic profile and characteristic acid-alcohol balance. This eco-geo-pedological context has been valorised over time by people, from the Ligurians to today's producers. Over the generations, these producers have found the adequacy between it and an original production, a production with a strong identity that has permitted the expression of the know-how of a whole community, offering to the wines a strong typicity linked to the terroir. This without any effect of fashion, in a Provençal context better known in 2010 for its majority production of rosé wines. The producers have clearly made the choice of a particular viticultural strategy, with the evolution of the white grape varieties towards the marsanne B and clairette B pairing, the definition of a low yield at 45 hectolitres per hectare, without the possibility of increase, to affirm their identity. The limitation of the yields, to the benefit of a particular and constant attention to quality, confers on the wine of "Cassis" its racy and precious character, which is not without recalling what Frédéric MISTRAL already wrote in his poem "Calendal": "the bee has no sweeter honey, it shines like a limpid diamond, smells of rosemary, heather and myrtle, which covers our hills…".

XI. – Transitional measures

No particular provision.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin "Cassis" is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

2° – Particular provisions

The labelling of the wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the name of a smaller geographical unit, subject to: - it being a registered cadastral lieu-dit; - it appearing on the harvest declaration.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Declaration of renunciation to produce

Where applicable, the operator sends, before 15 July, to the defence and management body a declaration of renunciation to produce that may bear on all or part of its production tool. The defence and management body informs the approved control body thereof.

2. Claim declaration

The claim declaration is sent to the defence and management body before 1 January of the year following that of the harvest and at least fifteen days before the first transaction or the first packaging. The defence and management body will transmit this declaration to the approved control body. It indicates: - the appellation claimed; - the volume of the wine; - the EVV or SIRET number; - the name and address of the applicant; - the place of storage of the wine. It is accompanied by: - a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for the buyers of grapes and musts; - the general plan of the places of storage, permitting in particular the number, the designation and the capacity of the containers to be identified.

3. Prior declaration of transaction and of removal

Every operator wishing to market a non-packaged wine of the controlled designation of origin makes to the approved control body and to the defence and management body a transaction declaration. This is established for the lot concerned between the day of the contractualisation of the transaction and within a minimum time limit of 15 days before the removal. The lot is defined as a homogeneous whole arising from one or more containers.

4. Prior declaration of packaging

a) – For the vinifying operators: A prior declaration of packaging is made to the approved control body within a minimum time limit of 5 days before the start of the packaging, and this for each vintage and each colour of wine. Each packaged lot is the subject of the reservation of a witness sample kept for at least six months after the date of packaging. The lot is defined as a homogeneous whole arising from one or more containers. The prior declaration of packaging is valid at most until 31 December of the year in the course of which it was made.

b) – For the other operators: Every operator wishing to package a wine of the controlled designation of origin makes to the approved control body a prior declaration of packaging for the lot concerned within a time limit of one week preceding the packaging. Each packaged lot is the subject of the reservation of a witness sample kept for at least six months after the date of packaging. The lot is defined as a homogeneous whole arising from one or more containers.

5. Declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

Every operator wishing to carry out a dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin makes the declaration thereof to the approved control body at least ten working days before the dispatch.

6. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin makes the declaration thereof to the defence and management body and to the approved control body within a time limit of fifteen days maximum after this downgrading.

II. – Keeping of registers

No particular provision.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area.	Documentary check and check in the field.
A2 – Claimable production potential (training method, proportion rules, entry of the vines into production).	Documentary check and check in the field.

B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard. — Claimable potential.	Documentary check.
Pruning.	Check in the field.
Average maximum load per parcel.	Check in the field.
Irrigation.	Documentary check and check in the field.
Overall upkeep and other cultivation practices.	Check in the field.
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes. — Ripeness of the grapes.	Documentary check.
B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage. — Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume.	On-site check.
Packaging.	Documentary check and on-site check.
B4 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration. — Missing vines.	Documentary check (keeping up to date of the list) and check in the field.
Authorised yield.	Documentary check (check of the declarations).
Claim declaration.	Documentary check and on-site check (compliance with the arrangements and time limits, concordance with the harvest declaration…). Check of the placing into circulation of the products.
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Wines at the stage of the movement between approved warehouse keepers or at the stage of placing on the market for the consumer.	Documentary and/or analytical check; organoleptic examination.
Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory.	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all the lots.

II. – References concerning the control structure

National Institute of Origin and Quality (INAO)
12, rue Henri Rol-Tanguy
TSA 30003
93555 – Montreuil Cedex
Tel: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.00
Email: contact@inao.gouv.fr

The check of compliance with the present specification is carried out on the basis of an approved control plan and by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence having received delegation from the INAO.

The inspection plan sets out the self-checks carried out by the operators on their own activity and the internal checks carried out under the responsibility of the defence and management body. It indicates the external checks carried out by the third-party body as well as the analytical and organoleptic examinations. The whole of the checks is carried out by sampling. Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory are the subject of a systematic analytical and organoleptic check.